

Are our Ministers and Teachers too Retiring?

Dr. Leon Roth, sometime head of the Jewish Theological Seminary, is the distinguished scholar who was invited to give the annual address at this year's Jewish College Speech Day. His address (the beginning of which is slightly amended) is being published in this paper; the first part appears below.

THE notepaper of Jews' College is headed: "Jews' College, London. Established 1856. For the Education and Training of Rabbis, Ministers, Preachers, Readers, and Teachers of Religion, for Jewish Congregations." In this heading I noted, or thought I noted, two things: first, that the future rabbis and so on are being trained not to be scholars (although that is the first essential and bedrock of all) but

THE Psalmist tells us that the "days of our years" are "three score and ten; and seventy has been accepted as the norm, the allotted span of man's life on earth. But the Psalmist admitted that "by reason of strength" this span may sometimes be stretched to eighty years. One has but to read the inscriptions on tombstones to realise how arbitrary these numbers are. Many, alas, are cut off their prime, long before their years have reached the eighth decade. Yet others live far beyond the Psalmist's span, reaching an age he left unsung.

It is with these unsung, the centenarians of Anglo-Jewry's tercentenary, that this article is concerned. Apart from the illustrious Sir Moses Montefiore, they are scarcely known, even by name. What more appropriate in this year marking three centuries of our story in these isles than that tribute be paid to other records of a hundred years?

RABBI & AUDIENCE

By LEON ROTH, F.B.A.

to serve Jewish congregations; and second, that there is no restriction, or at least no restriction is mentioned, on the type of Jewish congregation they are being trained to serve.

It is worth noting at once that the very title-deeds, as it were, of the College recognise the fact that the Rabbi, the Minister, the Preacher, the Reader, the Teacher of Religion is required by the very nature of his vocation not only to possess, but also to communicate, knowledge; and he is required to communicate his knowledge not to a select circle of colleagues but generally to the whole congregation. But here lies a peculiar, indeed, I fancy, a unique, difficulty. Other teachers and speakers have their proper audience in front of them and they know it; they speak to a pleader has his court, a school teacher his class, a university lecturer his degree or research students. But when a Minister speaks his proper audience (may I be blunt?) is largely absent. He is speaking to an audience in special need of his instruction do not come to him to be taught. When he preaches he preaches to the converted. But what about those who pray away? The world is full, the congregations are empty, of Jews who have no use for Judaism.

Absent from the Synagogue

Of course, they can be ignored; or they can be dismissed as materialists, atheists, sons of Belial, or whatever the current expression of disapproval may be. That seems to me to be far too easy; and in many cases it is simply untrue. As a fact they include very large numbers of what are generally recognised as spiritually minded men. You will see them at any concert, at any theatre, at any lecture, in any club, as writers, artists, thinkers, scholars, of distinction. Some are genuinely, in the biblical phrase, seekers after God. Many others are nearer our own level, simple folk, business or professional men. It is no use saying that they should come to synagogue. The fact is that they do not.

Looking for Guidance

It is this (may I suggest?) which is your special task. We members of Jewish congregations are exempt. We want a great deal from you. We look to you not only to conduct religious services and to stand at our side in times of family joys and sorrows. We look to you not only for instruction when we are faced with some doubtful point of "din," some crux of exegesis, some problem of history or ceremony. We look to you to be (please forgive the cliché) our "guide, philosopher, and friend" as well. We want to be able to refer to you, and to refer our children to you, in our intellectual and spiritual troubles. All this I am not saying anything new; and I need only point to the example of your learned Principal in illustration of what I am driving at. Dr. Epstein has set himself, for many years now, the arduous task of providing his community not only with translations of ancient texts but also with a modern presentation of the Way of Life, and of the Faith, which is Judaism. You can say: "But if so, the work has been done. We can always refer the inquirer to that, or the other

constantly to the new questions; and it may well be that the new questions will require new answers altogether. Thus the future Rabbi and preacher and Teacher of Religion has in the first place to be brought into contact, not with answers but with questions. For this purpose a college is all-important, and you are lucky in being members of one. For a college is not just a lecturing institution, it is, to quote the dictionary definition, an "organised society of persons performing certain common functions." The important words in this definition are "society" and "persons." A college is a "society"—that is, a diversity, unity expressed in diversity, diversity joined in unity: that is life itself—think of the variety and diversity of contribution to the common functioning of the one body made by our different organs and limbs. This is the ideal symbolised by the conception of a college and realised in the fact of a college. Like life itself, a college exists by virtue of the variety of talent and opinion assembled within its walls.

Widening the Scope

I know you are not, or are not yet, a residential college. But even a non-residential college a similar result can be attained by offering the privilege of membership to the widest possible diversity of student. And here your College is particularly fortunate in being appointed, as I have marked before, for the training of Rabbis, Ministers, Preachers, and Teachers of the Jewish Religion for all Jewish congregations. This 'should ensure the admission to the College of students of all kinds of religious views and of all kinds of religious destinations. Through them and their presence your professors and lecturers receive more stimulus, have their powers more

Continued in next column

The Career of John Monash

By ELIZABETH BENNETT

amazing enough that Monash attained to the heights that he did—namely the command of the Australian Corps in France in 1918. He was not a professional soldier. In addition, he was the only Jew to reach a corps command in that war. Furthermore, there is no doubt that his German origin caused a good deal of prejudice against him. It is perhaps understandable: in the First World War to be a Jew was not an automatic proof of loyalty to the Allied cause.

John Monash was born in Melbourne in 1865. His parents, Louis Monash and Bertha Manasse, had been born and married in Germany. His childhood was spent in the Victorian country town of Jerilderie (chiefly famous in Australian history as the place where Ned Kelly, the bush-ranger, once held up the bank!). Later his family came back to Melbourne, where he was educated at Scotch College and at Melbourne University. Eventually he graduated in Arts, Engineering, and Law, having studied for the law degree in his spare time, when he was already married and practising as an engineer. He specialised in rail, road, bridge, and water supply design and construction. Ahead of his colleagues he saw the great possibilities of reinforced concrete as a building material, and was the first to use it in Australia—and a most successful one—solidifying it with his hobby, and he followed it with characteristic thoroughness. At the outbreak of war in 1914 he was then aged 49; he was in the Colonies, had set himself up as a Colonel in the Australian Citizen Forces. His first active command was of one of the Australian brigades engaged in the Anzac campaign at Gallipoli. In 1916 he was given command of a division, and he was promoted to Major-General.

which he trained in England and then led in France during the terrific battles of the next year. In 1918 he succeeded Sir William Birdwood as Australian Corps Commander. He was the first Australian-born citizen to hold this command. Under his leadership the Australian troops won a tremendous reputation in the general advance of 1918. In particular, the success of the battle of August 8 and the capture of Mont St. Quentin were largely due to him and to the fine soldiers he commanded. He recorded the story of that year in his book "The Australian Victories in France in 1918." A man of great planning and organising ability, Monash eventually compelled the admiration of even the most critical professional soldiers.

Yet he was a man who genuinely hated war, as his published letters testify, and he did not remain in the army any longer than was necessary when victory had been won. After organising the repatriation of all the Australian troops from Europe and the Middle East he returned thankfully to Melbourne and his work as an engineer. In that he gained fresh fame as the architect and creator of the Victorian State electricity scheme. His other interests in those years were of a more domestic nature. Zionism was one of them—a fact which is recorded in the naming of an Israeli kibbutz after him. The University of Melbourne was another of his interests, and he was its Vice-Chancellor until his death. In addition, the Australian Government sent him as their official representative at the inauguration of New Delhi in 1931.

Many countries honoured Monash with decorations for his services in the war, and he was awarded honorary degrees. When he died in 1931, at the age of 66, this Jewish engineer and soldier was probably the most famous and respected Australian of his time. [Copyright]

Some Centenarians of the Tercentenary

ing "The Longevity of the Jews," one correspondent attributed this to Jewish healthiness, obviously then a noted trait, to the Jewish abstinence from port, both fresh and salted. Further, he added, all medical observers concurred in testifying to the superior longevity of Jews as compared with the general population.

This is amply borne out by the list of Jewish centenarians, complete as far as the writer has been able to make it. Within less than a hundred years after Manasseh ben-Israel pleaded so eloquently for Jewish redemption, we have the first record. It is that of Samuel Cardoso. He died in 1753 and was buried in the Sephardi cemetery; his age being given as 100 years. Ten years later Moses Sulima died at the age of 110. Nothing except their names and ages is known of either. The next centenarian, who died in 1765 at the age of 102, is Rabbi Shmely, a Polish Jew. It is known that he attended the celebration of the Feast of Tabernacles in his last year, and that he had a beard 19 inches long.

Four years later, in 1769, Moses Amiel died at the age of 99; he enjoyed to his last moment the use of all his faculties. Solomon Raphael Levy, of St. Giles, had reached the age of 100 when he died in 1771. His record was equalled by Isaac Benjamin, who died in 1775, aged 108, being then, the journals of the day declared, "the oldest Jew in England, leaving twelve sons resident in England."

A few years later, in 1782, the name of the first of the women centenarians appears—Sarah Joseph, who died at the age of 107 years and 10 months. Lyons, who records this fact in his "Evivrons of London," adds: "The keener of the burial record assured me that she was a year older." He mentions also, but without giving any name, a centenarian Dutch Jew buried near Ducking-pond Row, Bethnal Green, a cemetery adjoining to the synagogue of Bricklayers' Hall, Leadenhall Street, in the City of London.

Woman aged 110

The second woman centenarian, Rachael Solomon, died one year later, 1783, at the age of 110. Beyond this fact, nothing is known of her. In the same year, Jacobbe Cervetto, the first famous centenarian, died at the age of 101. He was the best known violinist of his day and was born in Italy. His real name was Bassano, but he adopted the name of Cervetto in 1728, when, as a dealer in Italian musical instruments, he came to London. It is thought that this latter name points to a German origin, for it means "little stag," a translation of the popular Yiddish

name "Hirschel." For several years he was solo 'cellist at Drury Lane, later succeeding Garrick as manager—with great financial gain. He popularised the violinello in England, and was a well-known performer, conspicuous for his large nose and the huge flashing diamond ring worn on the forefinger of his bow hand. He was very popular with the Drury Lane audience, especially the galletries, whose cry "Play up, Nossy," became a theme chant. He amassed a large fortune and became a convert to Christianity.

Two years later—1785—David Levi Solomon, "a Jewish rabbi," aged 100, died in Moorfields. Also in the same year, died the famous Mrs. Maria Anna Moses, described as "a rich Jewess of Whitechapel." She left £10,000 to be divided among the Jewish poor.

The next centenarian, Sarah Lyon, born in 1703 in Holland, had the distinction of having her portrait painted by Constable at the age of 101. She died in 1808 and was buried in Ipswich, where she had lived many years. In a letter to Tins Jewess Chronicle of July 5, 1806, "A Descendant" relates that she came to England from Holland, with an infant son nine months old, later known as the Rev. Isaac Titterman. When an old man his portrait was also painted by Constable. He was renowned for his goodness. Over his door was inscribed in Hebrew "Let all who are hungry enter and eat." This inscription attracted the attention of Lord George Gordon—and resulted in their friendship. It is thought that Titterman was the minister who brought Lord George into the Jewish fold.

In 1810, at the age of 103, Hannah Levy died. The burial record of the sole record, while THE GLEANER of August 27, 1823, gives the death of Joseph Moses, a street trader, at 112 1/2 near Ducking-pond Row, Bethnal Green, a cemetery adjoining to the synagogue of Bricklayers' Hall, Leadenhall Street, in the City of London.

Two years separated the deaths of a unique class of Jewry and the centenarians. In 1833 Judith Cohen, aged 101, died in Coventry. On December 13, 1835, Isaac Cohen, her husband, who had lived in Coventry a mere 100 years, died there at the age of 109. This is all that is recorded of this exceptional married couple.

Stirrer-up of Troubles!

But if merely a record of name and age is the portion of so many centenarians, this can scarcely be said to be the case of the freemason of Anglo-Jewish publishers, Levy Alexander, who died in 1853 in his hundredth year. He was the son of the first English Jewish typographer; and himself was printer, publisher, translator of the Hebrew liturgy, as well as English grammarian, scurrilous writer, and stirrer-up of communal troubles. He wrote fearlessly about whatever met with his disapproval or outraged his sense of justice, and no doubt he did much to disturb the smug complacency of his coreligionists. When the Chief Rabbi, Rabbi Hirschel, went to view a balloon ascent on a Saturday, Alexander accused him of desecrating the Sabbath. When Rabbi Hirschel ordered trees to be felled in the old burial ground in Mile End, he wrote, printed, and published a pamphlet entitled "The Axe Laid to the Root of the Tree," in which he urged for one of his temperaments of being able to rush into print whenever so inclined. The Haham, Raphael Meldola, no less than Rabbi Hirschel, came in for his strictures, Alexander referring in the very title of one pamphlet to "the stupidity" of the former. He used the very wrappers of the prayer-book he published in parts for attacking the rabbinical heads, using doggerel verse to heighten the effect. The community certainly smarted and suffered under his activities for a long, long period.

Died of Shock—at 105

Another remarkable centenarian was Joseph Levy, who like nearly all those already mentioned, was a freemason. He was born in the neighbourhood of Jewry Street in 1751. Both his parents had been born in England; his paternal grandfather, however, came from Prague at the end of the seventeenth century. At the age of 15 he went into business, married young, and had a family of 22 children. He died in 1856 at the age of 105. His death was due to "he was his Vice-Chancellor until his death. In addition, the Australian Government sent him as their official representative at the inauguration of New Delhi in 1931."

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IN THE PROVINCES

Manchester

EGYPTIAN JEWISH REFUGEES

Emergency Committee to be Set Up

From our Correspondent

A plan to establish in Manchester an emergency committee to deal with the problem of Egyptian Jewish refugees was announced by Mr. Samuel Glicher, J.P., President of the Council of Manchester and Salford Jews, at the monthly meeting of the Council on Sunday, at the Maccabi Buildings.

This followed a statement by Mr. J. Akribi, President of the Wellington Burial Society of Spanish and Portuguese Jews, who stated that there were at present about 70 Jewish refugees near Newcastle under Lyme who wanted to come to Manchester. He stated that "where there was a Jewish atmosphere" another 700 Egyptian Jews would shortly be arriving in this country, said Mr. Akribi, and he appealed to the Council to do everything in their power to help their unfortunate brethren.

In his presidential statement Mr.

NEW MATRON

To welcome Miss S. A. Stansfield, who recently took up her appointment as Matron of the Manchester Victoria Hospital, a party was held at the hospital last week when Alderman A. Moss, J.P., Chairman of the House Committee, members of the official consultant staff, resident medical officers, the House Committee, members of the visiting clergy, and others gathered to meet Miss S. A. Stansfield.

Miss Stansfield was formerly deputy matron at the Burnley General Hospital (which has 400 beds) and was one of the assistant matrons at the Christie Hospital.

Bournemouth

About £700 was raised at a ball given by Mrs. P. Schneider at the Majestic Hotel on Sunday in aid of hospital beds for Israel and Jewish Child's Day, and held under the auspices of the Ladies' Guild. The President of the Guild, Mrs. B. Sapiro, expressed thanks to all who gave their help.

The Talmud group which meets every Sabbath in the synagogue after mincha recently took part in a symposium on Talmud which was conducted by Rabbi J. Indech.

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Leeds

ZION HOUSE DEDICATED

Distinguished Guests at Ceremony

From our Correspondent

The ceremony of the dedication of Zion House (in memory of Mr. Joseph Gillingson) and the Annie Brostoff Hall and Morris Silman Room, and the endowment of the Gertrude Rosenthal Room were held last week. Among the guests of honour were Mr. R. Amir, Israeli Consul-General; Mrs. S. Brodetsky, Mrs. G. Gillingson, Mrs. E. Silman, Mr. M. Brostoff, and Mrs. G. Rosenthal.

Cousin K. C. Cohen, Chairman of the Leeds Zionist Council, opened the ceremony, invited Mrs. Gillingson to unveil a plaque at the entrance to Zion House in memory of the late Mr. J. Gillingson.

The Annie Brostoff Hall was formally dedicated by Mr. Max Brostoff, the Morris Silman Room by Mrs. E. Silman, and the Gertrude Rosenthal Room endowed by Mrs. G. Rosenthal—all of whom certificates commemorating the event were presented to them by Mr. Brostoff.

Mr. Bertram Benas, C.B.E., President of the Leeds Jewish Community, presided at the ceremony, which was held in the Cheetham Public Hall, which raised £1,600.

In response to an emergency appeal for £200 has been raised so far by the Society. Mrs. N. Coleman showed coloured slides which were taken on her recent visit to Israel.

DAUGHTERS OF ZION

At the annual meeting of the Manchester Daughters of Zion held last week the Treasurer, Mrs. S. Mendelsohn, presented the balance sheet which showed a record income over £6,000.

Among those elected were Mrs. I. Burak, President; Mrs. S. Mendelsohn, Treasurer; Mrs. B. Sapiro, Secretary; and Mrs. L. Bawa, Hon. Secretary.

Reports were given by chairmen of the stalls at the recent bazaar held at the Cheetham Public Hall, which raised £1,600.

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GIFT OF ARK

An Ark for the Beth Hamidrash of the Holy Law Congregation, presented by Mr. Montague Jacobs, and a Parochet presented by Mrs. M. A. Jacobs, were consecrated at a service held recently, at which Rabbi J. Undersford and the Rev. R. Berkovits officiated. At a Sijum held on the completion of the Parochet Rosh Hashana by Rabbi Undersford and the study group, the Hadran was given by Dayan I. Goldich.

Birmingham

J.P.A. OFFICERS

From our Correspondent

At the first committee meeting of the 1957 J.P.A. Emergency Campaign the following officers were elected: Mr. C. Pearl, President; Mr. Ivan Short, J.P., Chairman; Mr. I. Baum, Vice-Chairman; Mr. G. Blumenthal, Treasurer; Mr. S. Sapiro, Secretary; and Mr. Cyril Cornberg, Chairman, Convalescent Committee.

J.L.B. HEADQUARTERS

The Council of the Birmingham Hebrew Congregation has offered a large room adjoining the Hebrew schools for the exclusive use of the J.L.B.

To make the room habitable and to provide equipment, it is estimated that £500 has to be raised. As a result the Brigade will have permanent headquarters for parades, P.T., boxing, and games. It is expected that an official opening will shortly be held.

The Treasurer of the Advisory Committee is Mr. H. Harman, 18 Augustus Road, Edgbaston, Birmingham, 15.

Harrogate

NEARLY £7,000 RAISED AT START OF J.P.A.

From our Correspondent

The opening meeting of the J.P.A. campaign, held in the Rose Goodman Schoolroom, Harrogate, last week, raised a record amount—nearly £7,000.

Mr. Stanley Burton, President of the Harrogate Zionist Society, presided and Mr. Leon Mizrahi, who recently arrived from Israel, described the situation there and also the plight of the Jews in Egypt.

Other speakers included Mr. L.M. Bodendey, the Rev. J. H. Rockman, and the Rev. J. H. Rockman.

Cardiff

SILVER TICKET BALL

From our Correspondent

Over 800 guests attended the annual Silver Ticket Ball in aid of the Agudat Home at the City Hall, Cardiff.

The hosts were Mr. and Mrs. Syd Levine and among those present were the Lord Mayor and Lady Mayors of Cardiff (Alderman D. T. Williams, J.P., and Mrs. Williams), the Deputy Mayor, Aldermen, and Councillors.

Mrs. Isabella Bernstein, Treasurer of the Cardiff Hebrew Congregation, announced that £1,200 had been raised by means of the souvenir brochure.

Chatham

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Dr. Hilda Elman (Mrs. Hilda Geo) the only woman councillor on the Council of the Rochester City Council, has been appointed a Justice of the Peace on the Rochester Bench.

Dr. and Mrs. Geo are members of the Chatham Synagogue.

Liverpool

LITERARY SOCIETY'S 50TH ANNIVERSARY

Address by Lord Russell

From our Correspondent

Lord Russell of Liverpool gave an address at a meeting at the Royal Institution last week to commemorate the 50th anniversary of the constitution of the Liverpool Jewish Literary Society, which has been the first Lord Russell of Liverpool and editor for 46 years of the LIVERPOOL DAILY POST—addressed on three occasions.

Lord Russell devoted his address to relating some of his experiences in, and impressions of, Israel, which he had visited twice this year. He pointed out that Mr. Ben-Gurion had agreed to withdraw his troops from Sinai; he could not have done more to prove Israel's bona fides, and everyone should realize that Israel sought peace and that Nasser wanted war.

Mr. Bertram Benas, C.B.E., President of the Liverpool Jewish Community, presided at the meeting of Dr. I. J. Lipkin, J.P., who was accompanied by the Mayores (Mrs. Harris).

The evening was organised by the Jewish Women's Personal Service Guild (whose President, Mrs. I. J. Lipkin, was in the chair), assisted by most of the women's organisations and the Friendship Club. A vote of the thanks to the Mayor was proposed by Mr. I. Karp and acknowledged by the Mayores.

GREENBANK DRIVE CONGREGATION

At the semi-annual meeting on Sunday of the Greenbank Drive Congregation Mr. J. Morris and others urged that immediate steps be taken to erect a building, to provide additional amenities for the synagogue hall, new classrooms, and a sukh.

A major recommendation of the Council for the appointment of a particular candidate to the office of chazan—which has been vacant since 1935—was rejected.

Mr. L. Bieber, Senior Warden, who presided, praised the "successful and scholarly" sermons delivered by the Senior Minister, Rabbi I. Karp.

RAV'S RESIDENCE

The dwelling-house, 91 Dunabin Road, has been acquired as a residence for the Rav of Liverpool, and the Shechita Board, whose property the house will remain, has contributed £3,500 towards the cost.

Luton

JOURNALIST'S PROGRESS

From our Correspondent

News has reached Luton from America this week of the progress of the Jewish journalist, once a German refugee in England.

He is Mr. Walter W. Grunfeld, who has recently become editor and publisher of the MARATHON INDEPENDENT, the local newspaper of the town of Marathon, New York State.

Mr. Grunfeld, a nephew of Dayan Grunfeld, of London, was evacuated to Luton during the war soon after he arrived in this country from Germany. He was educated at the Grammar School, became a reporter on the BIGGLESWADE CHRONICLE on leaving school, and afterwards joined Reuters. He left for the United States and there he joined the staff of the WAVELEY Sun, and later became its editor.

As a result of a meeting held recently a branch of the British Technion Committee may be formed in Luton, meeting will be addressed by Lord and Lady Straboloff, Dr. A. Sharf, Mr. A. Rein, and the Rev. H. D. Rivin.

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